

6-MONTH CAREER ROADMAP

From Working Professional (Cloud & Web Dev) → Application Security & AI Security Specialist

■ CURRENT POSITION

Role: Working Professional
Core Skills: Cloud (AWS/Azure/GCP), Web Development
Edge: Understands systems & infra that need securing — a strong launchpad into security.

■ TARGET GOAL

Target Role: App Security + AI Security Specialist
Timeline: 6 Months (aggressive, achievable)
Differentiator: Cloud+Dev background lets you skip generic IT-security ramp-up.

■ SKILL GAP ANALYSIS

Area	Have	Gap to Close
AppSec Fundamentals	Web Dev knowledge	OWASP Top 10, secure coding, threat modeling
Cloud Security	AWS/Azure/GCP basics	IAM hardening, CSPM, misconfig audits, cloud-native security tools
AI / LLM Security	None yet	Prompt injection, model/data poisoning, OWASP LLM Top 10
Tooling & Practice	None yet	Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, scripting for security automation
Credibility	Professional experience	Security+ / equivalent cert, bug bounty track record, portfolio

■ LEARNING PLAN

Phase	Focus
M1–M2	Security fundamentals: OWASP Top 10, secure coding, networking/OS basics, start Security+ study
M3–M4	Cloud security specialization: IAM, CSPM tools, container/K8s security, pentesting practice (Burp/ZAP)
M5	AI/LLM security: prompt injection, adversarial ML, OWASP LLM Top 10, securing AI pipelines
M6	Portfolio polish, mock interviews, applications, networking push

■ SUGGESTED PROJECTS

- Web App Pentest** — break & document OWASP Juice Shop / DVWA
- Cloud Misconfig Auditor** — Python script scanning AWS/Azure IAM & storage for insecure settings
- LLM Red-Team Project** — test a sample chatbot for prompt injection & build a mitigation layer
- Bug Bounty Reports** — 1–2 verified submissions on HackerOne/Bugcrowd

■ NETWORKING STRATEGY

- Post weekly on LinkedIn: security learnings, project write-ups, CTF/bug-bounty wins
- Join OWASP local chapter + AI security communities (Discord/Slack)
- Engage on r/netsec, X/Twitter security circles
- Attend 1–2 security meetups/webinars per month
- Directly connect with AppSec & AI-security practitioners; ask for 15-min chats

■ MONTHLY MILESTONES

Month	Milestone
1	OWASP Top 10 mastered; Security+ study started; secure-coding basics applied to past web projects
2	Security+ exam passed (or scheduled); Juice Shop/DVWA pentest project completed
3	Cloud security fundamentals (IAM/CSPM) learned; Burp Suite/ZAP proficiency built
4	Cloud misconfig auditor project shipped; first bug bounty submission made
5	AI/LLM security studied; LLM red-team project completed and documented publicly
6	Portfolio + resume finalized; actively interviewing; 500+ relevant LinkedIn connections

■ IMMEDIATE NEXT ACTIONS (THIS WEEK)

1. Enroll in a Security+ or OWASP Top 10 course
2. Install Burp Suite Community + set up OWASP Juice Shop locally
3. Post a LinkedIn intro: "Transitioning from Cloud/Dev into AppSec & AI Security — here's my plan"
4. Join 1 OWASP/AI-security community today